High-Level Design – Employee Management

TaskFlow – Intelligent Task Allocation & Tracking System

> **Document:** High-Level Design (sub-module EMP) · **Version:** 1.0 · **Status:** Draft
> **Project type:** Personal Project (Skill Development) · **Date:** 31-Oct-2026
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> **Module:** TaskFlow Management · **Sub-module:** 03.1 Employee Management (code `EMP`)
> **Based on:** BRD-Employee-Management v1.0, FRD-Employee-Management v1.0, TaskFlow as built
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Document Control

Version	Date	Author	Summary of changes
1.0	31-Oct-2026	Jojo George	Initial version, derived from the Employee Management BRD/FRD and the code

Related documents:

Document	Location
Overall HLD (stack, deployment, cross-cutting design)	`../../00-Overall/HLD-TaskFlow-Overall.md`
BRD – Employee Management	`../../../BRD/03-TaskFlow-Management/03.1-Employee-Management/BRD-Employee-Management.md`
FRD – Employee Management	`../../../FRD/03-TaskFlow-Management/03.1-Employee-Management/FRD-Employee-Management.md`
LLD – Employee Management	`../../../LLD/03-TaskFlow-Management/03.1-Employee-Management/LLD-Employee-Management.md`
Sibling HLDs	`../03.2-Project-Management/HLD-Project-Management.md`, `../03.3-Department-Management/HLD-Department-Management.md`
TDD	`TF - Documents/TF - TDD/TDD-TaskFlow.md` (§3 architecture, §6.6 authorization, §7 data model)

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This HLD describes how Employee Management is built: where it sits in TaskFlow, its frontend and backend components, how it works with the other sub-modules, the data it owns and uses, its key

flows, its security design and the design decisions behind it. Classes, methods, columns and the full endpoint list are in the LLD.

1.2 Scope

In scope: the employee list (search and filters), the employee details side panel (derived managers, Manager's team, MFA reset), the add / edit employee side panel (role, departments, project allocations on create, temporary password, status), activation / deactivation, soft delete and the effect of these actions on sessions, manager links and notifications.

Out of scope: sign-in, token issue and the MFA set-up flow (overall HLD, Authentication); department membership after creation (Department Management HLD); project teams after creation and positions (Project Management HLD); role and permission editing (Role Configuration HLD); the user's own profile (My Profile HLD).

Change from original BRD (Screen 5): the design serves the current requirement – Project / Role / Status filters instead of a Department filter, soft delete blocked only by **unfinished** tasks, last-Administrator and own-account protection, project allocations, MFA reset and immediate session end (see BRD-Employee-Management §5).

1.3 Audience

Developer, reviewer and tester of TaskFlow (Jojo George); anyone maintaining the account and access logic.

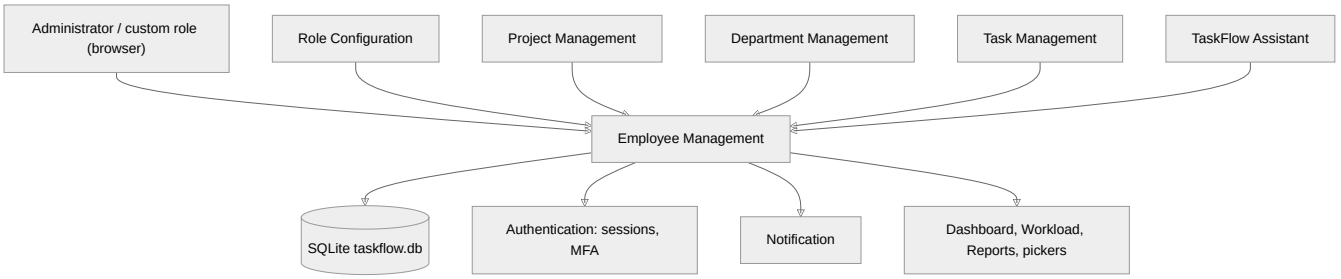
1.4 Definitions & Abbreviations

Term	Meaning
SPA	Single Page Application (Angular frontend)
EMP / PROJ / DEPT	Employee, Project and Department Management sub-modules
Live employee	A `User` row that is not soft-deleted
Security stamp	A per-user random value carried in the access token; changing it invalidates every session
Derived manager	A manager computed from a person's department managers and project-manager flags
Allocation	A person's whole percentage (1–100) on one project, with a position
Employee action permission	Any of `employees.create`, `employees.edit`, `employees.status.change`, `employees.delete`, `employees.role.assign`, `employees.mfa.reset`

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2. System Context

2.1 Context Diagram



2.2 Actors & External Systems

Actor / system	Interaction	Protocol
Administrator	Uses the Employee Management screen	HTTPS (JSON REST, Bearer JWT)
Custom role user	Uses the screen when holding at least one employee action permission	HTTPS
Manager	No screen; reads the people list through other screens (task assignee picker, team pickers) with `employees.view`	HTTPS
TaskFlow Assistant	Applies a confirmed role change through `EmployeeService`	In-process call
Employee whose access changes	Next request with an old session is rejected; receives the MFA-reset notification	HTTPS / in-app notification
External systems	None – no email, no third-party service	–

3. Architecture Goals, Constraints & Principles

3.1 Quality Goals

Goal	How the architecture supports it
Security – immediate effect	Access changes rotate the user's security stamp and revoke refresh tokens; `SessionValidation` checks the stamp on every request (NFR-EMP-01)
Security – server enforcement	Every action has a permission policy; role-sensitive changes have extra server-side checks (NFR-EMP-02)
Data integrity	Unique indexes on email and username over all rows (including deleted) back the service checks, so a race ends in 409, not a duplicate (NFR-EMP-06)
History preservation	Soft delete keeps the account row, so tasks, comments and mail keep their author (BR-EMP-07)
Lock-out protection	The last-Administrator rule sits in the service layer and guards role change, deactivation and deletion (BR-EMP-04)
Maintainability	Layer-first structure with module sub-folders; allocation rules live in one shared service used by EMP and PROJ

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3.2 Constraints

- Single API process and one SQLite file; no paging of the employee list (all live users are returned).
- Fixed email domain `taskflow.com` (code constant in `EmailPolicy`).
- Only the system roles Administrator (id 1), Manager (id 2) and Employee (id 3) have built-in meaning (`SystemRoles`).
- Shared cross-cutting pipeline (JWT, MFA gate, validation, error mapping) – see the overall HLD.

3.3 Architecture Principles

- Controller → Service → Repository; the service commits through `IUnitOfWork`.
- The server decides access; the SPA only hides what the user cannot do.
- One owner per table: EMP owns `User`; it writes allocation and membership rows only when an employee is created and when manager duties are cleared.
- Reporting lines are derived data, never stored as a typed value.

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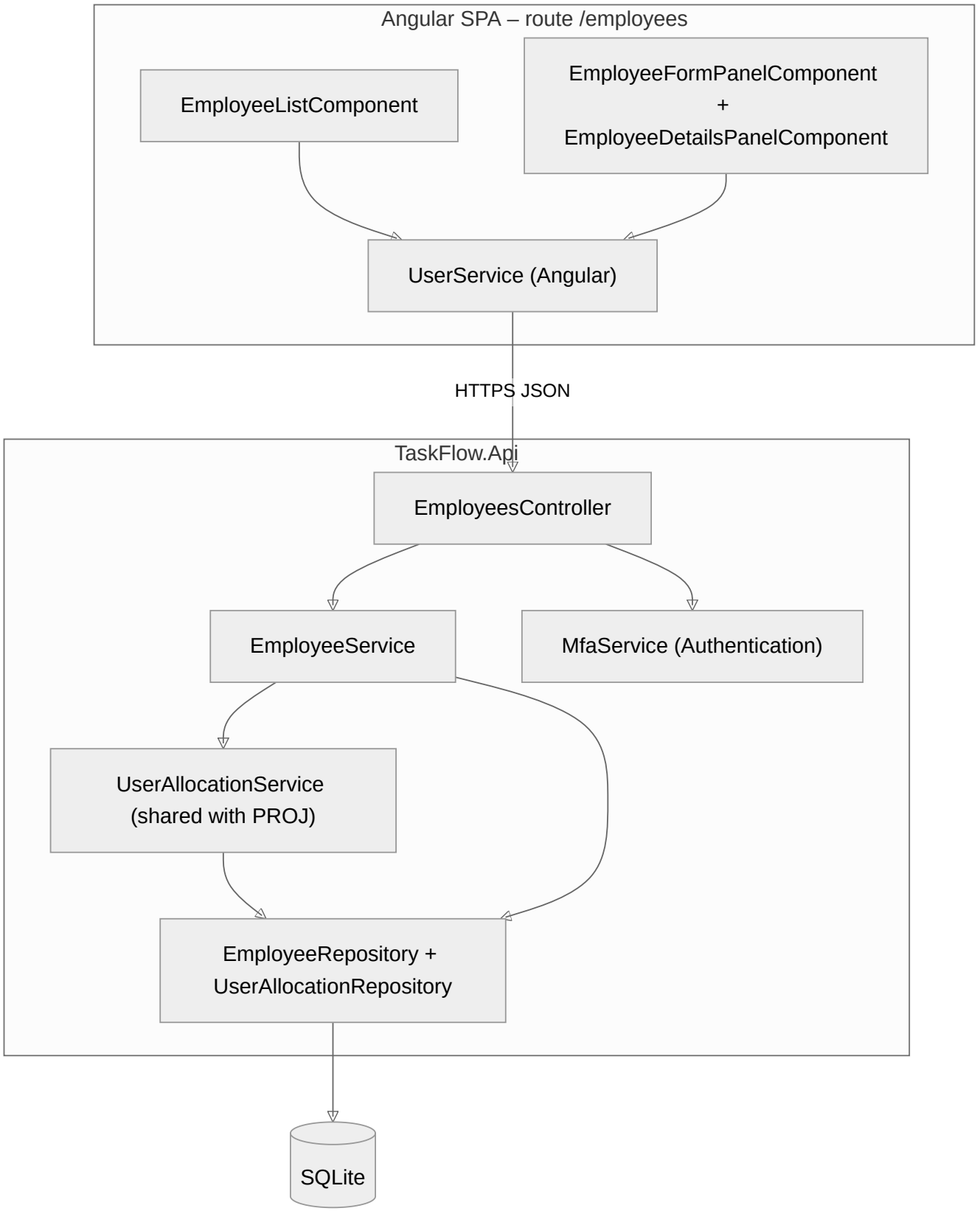
4. Architecture Overview

4.1 Architecture Style

Part of the TaskFlow three-tier design: Angular SPA → ASP.NET Core REST API (`/api/v1/users`) → SQLite through EF Core. The sub-module is a vertical slice: one lazy SPA route with a list page and two side panels, one controller, one domain service plus the shared allocation service, and repositories.

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4.2 Logical Architecture



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4.3 Layers & Responsibilities

Layer	Responsibility in EMP	May call
Presentation	Route guard, menu item, list with filters, details and form panels, permission-driven buttons, client checks (100% bar, password strength)	API
API / Controller	Permission policies, inline role-assignment checks, current-user id, HTTP status mapping	Services
Services	Uniqueness, email policy, role existence, last-Administrator and self-delete rules, unfinished-task check, session end, manager-duty clean-up, allocation validation	Repositories, Authentication (MFA), Notification publisher
Repositories	Live-user queries, filtered list, derived managers / team, uniqueness lookups ignoring the soft-delete filter	Database
Integrations	None of its own; uses the shared password hasher and the Authentication MFA service	–

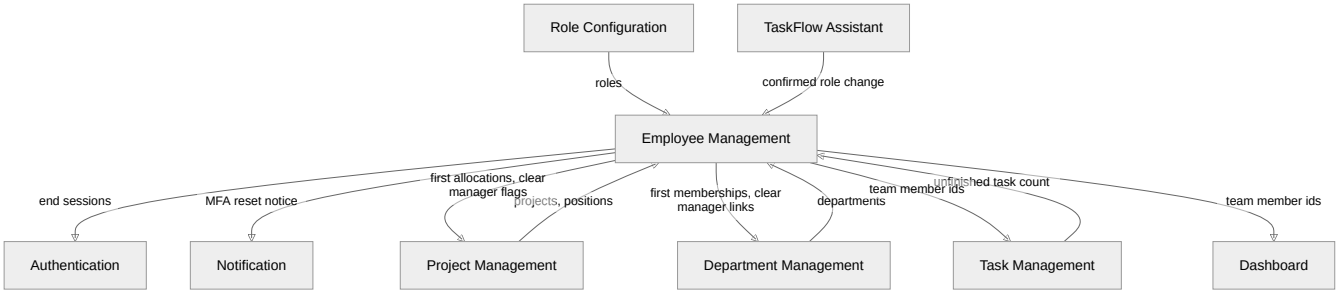
5. Component / Module Design

Component	Responsibility	Key parts (high level)	Depends on
Route and menu	Show the screen only to holders of an employee action permission; others go to their dashboard	`/employees` route with `permissionGuard`, `EmployeeScreenPermissions`, menu item in `nav-items.ts`	`AuthService` permission claims
Employee list page	Organisation-wide list, server-side search and filters, row actions, confirmations	`EmployeeListComponent` (debounced search, latest-request-wins)	`UserService`, Angular `ProjectService` / `DepartmentService` / Role Configuration `RoleService` for filter and form lists
Details panel	Read-only view with derived managers, Manager's projects and team, two-step status, Reset MFA	`EmployeeDetailsPanelComponent`	`UserService`
Form panel	Add (all fields, departments, allocation rows, temporary password, status) and Edit (identity and role only)	`EmployeeFormPanelComponent`, `PositionComboboxComponent` (owned by PROJ)	`UserService`, positions API
Employee API	Eight actions on `/api/v1/users`: list, role options, one user, create, update, status, delete, MFA reset	`EmployeesController` with `[RequirePermission]` and inline checks for `employees.role.assign` / `roles.administrator.assign`	`EmployeeService`, `IMfaService`

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Component	Responsibility	Key parts (high level)	Depends on
Request validation	Required fields, lengths, password length, email format	FluentValidation validators run by `ValidationFilter`	`EmailPolicy`
Employee domain service	All account rules and side effects (uniqueness, last Administrator, self delete, unfinished tasks, session end, manager-duty clean-up)	`EmployeeService`	`EmployeeRepository`, `RoleRepository`, `RefreshTokenRepository`, `TaskRepository`, `UserAllocationService`, password hasher, `IUnitOfWork`
Allocation service (shared)	Validate and stage allocations and department memberships given on create; 100% cap	`UserAllocationService`, `UserAllocationRepository`	Project, position and department repositories
Employee repository	Filtered list, DTO projection with derived managers and team (batched joins), uniqueness lookups, team member ids for other modules	`EmployeeRepository`	`AppDbContext`
MFA reset (Authentication)	Clear the authenticator, end sessions, publish a System notification	`MfaService`	`NotificationPublisher`, `RefreshTokenRepository`

5.1 Module Interaction



Interaction	Direction	What flows
Authentication	EMP → AUTH	Security-stamp rotation and refresh-token revocation; MFA reset is executed by the Authentication `MfaService`
Notification	EMP → NOTIF	One System notification after an MFA reset; no other EMP action notifies
Role Configuration	ROLE → EMP	Assignable roles for the form and filter (`/api/v1/users/roles` ; Administrator listed only with `roles.administrator.assign`)
Project / Department Management	both ways	Lists for filters and the form; on create EMP writes the first allocation and membership rows; on demotion or deletion EMP clears project-manager flags, manager-project links and department-manager links
Task Management	both ways	EMP asks for the unfinished-task count before delete; Task Management and the manager dashboard read a manager's team from `EmployeeRepository`

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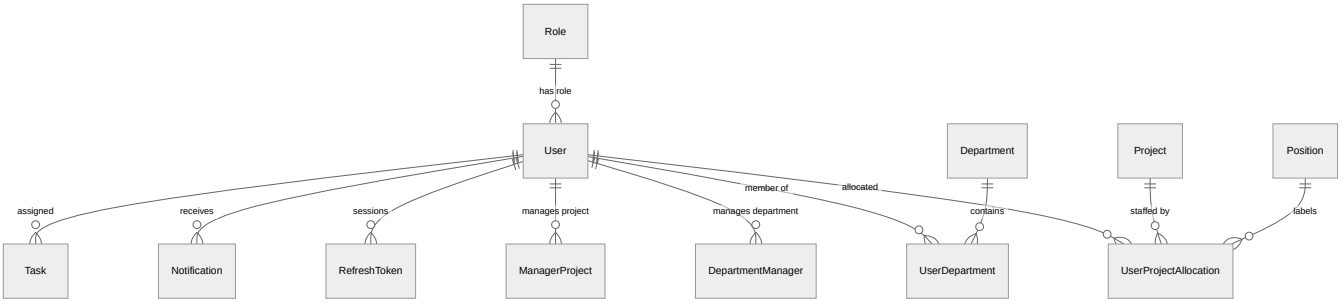
Interaction	Direction	What flows
TaskFlow Assistant	TFA → EMP	After the administrator confirms, `AssistantActionService` applies a role change through `EmployeeService`

6. Data Architecture (high level)

6.1 Data Stores

Store	Technology	Holds (for EMP)	Notes
Main database	SQLite `taskflow.db` (EF Core)	`User` (owned); allocation, membership and manager-link rows (shared); refresh tokens; notifications	Single file in the TaskFlow data folder; backup per the overall HLD
File storage	–	Nothing	EMP stores no files

6.2 Main Data Domains



Entity	Owner	EMP use
`User`	EMP	Create, update, status, soft delete; MFA state is managed by Authentication
`Role`	Role Configuration	Read (role of a user, role options)
`UserProjectAllocation`, `ManagerProject`, `Position`, `Project`	PROJ	Rows written on create; project-manager flag and links cleared on demotion / delete; read for the list and details
`UserDepartment`, `DepartmentManager`, `Department`	DEPT	Memberships written on create; manager links cleared on demotion / delete; read to derive managers
`RefreshToken`	Authentication	Revoked when sessions end
`Task`	Task Management	Unfinished assigned tasks counted before delete
`Notification`	Notification	One System notification on MFA reset

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6.3 Data Flow

1. **Create:** form → validated request → `EmployeeService` checks uniqueness (including deleted users), role and allocation / department rules → one save writes the `User` (hashed password, new security stamp) and its first allocation and membership rows.
2. **Read:** the list query filters live users and projects them with allocations, departments, MFA state and the derived managers and team, which are loaded in separate batched queries.
3. **Access change** (username or role change, deactivation, delete, MFA reset): the same save rotates the security stamp and revokes refresh tokens; the person's next request fails in `SessionValidation`.
4. **Delete:** soft delete; manager duties are removed, other link rows stay but are hidden by query filters, and the person's tasks, comments and mail keep pointing at the row.

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7. Integration Design

Integration	Direction	Purpose	Failure behaviour
Authentication (sessions)	Internal, outbound	End sessions after access changes	Part of the same database save; if the save fails nothing changes and the SPA shows "Could not update the employee."
Authentication (MFA)	Internal, outbound	Reset the authenticator	404 when the user is not live; the SPA shows "Could not reset MFA."
Notification publisher	Internal, outbound	MFA-reset notice	Published after the reset is saved
Role Configuration	Internal, inbound	Role options	The SPA falls back to the three standard roles and shows "Custom roles could not be loaded. Only the standard roles are listed."
Project / Department lists	Internal, inbound	Filter and form options	Errors are swallowed; lists stay empty (see §14)
External systems	–	None	–

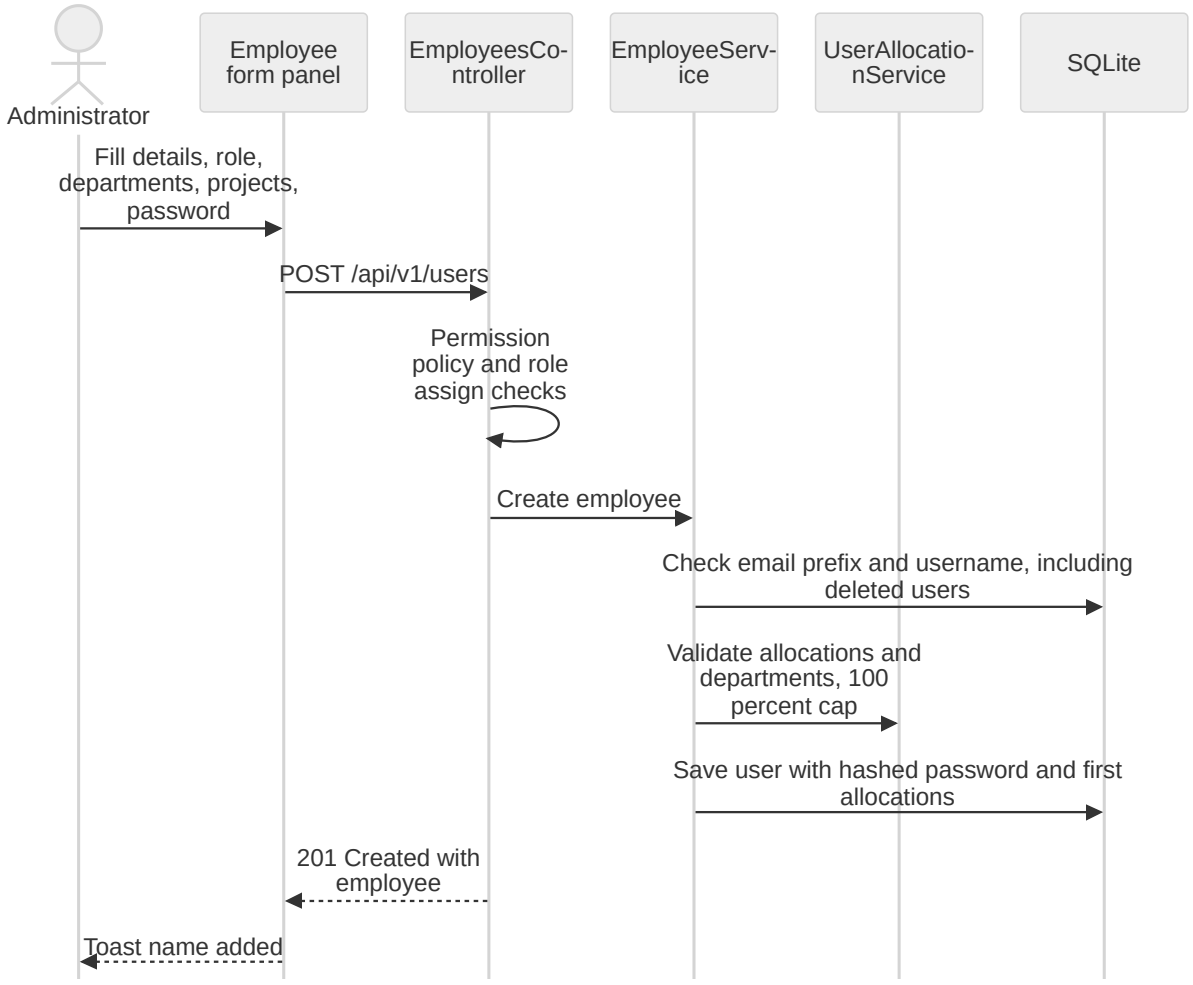
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8. Key Flows (high level)

Sign-in and the request pipeline are shown in the overall HLD. EMP has no background job (*not applicable for this sub-module*).

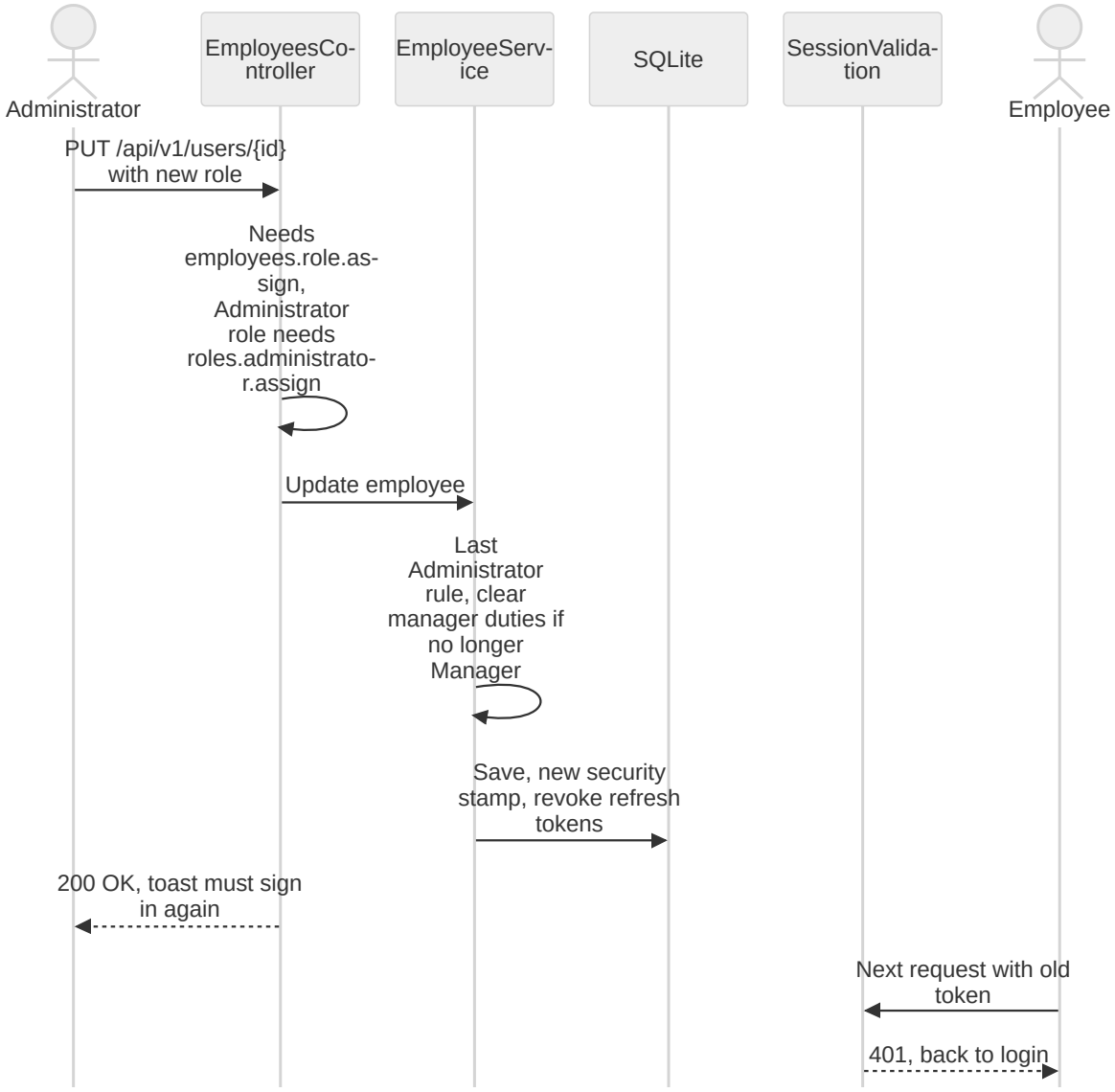
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8.1 Add an employee



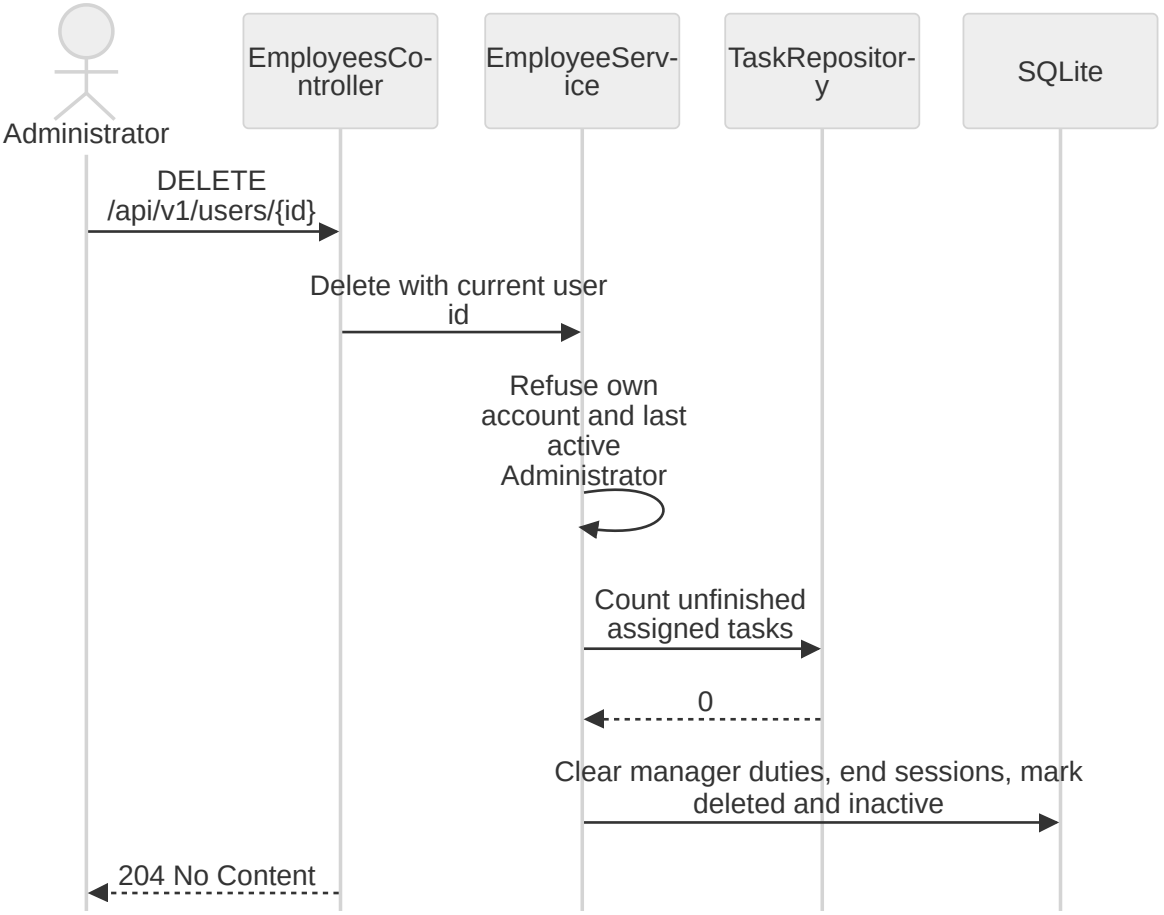
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8.2 Role change ends sessions



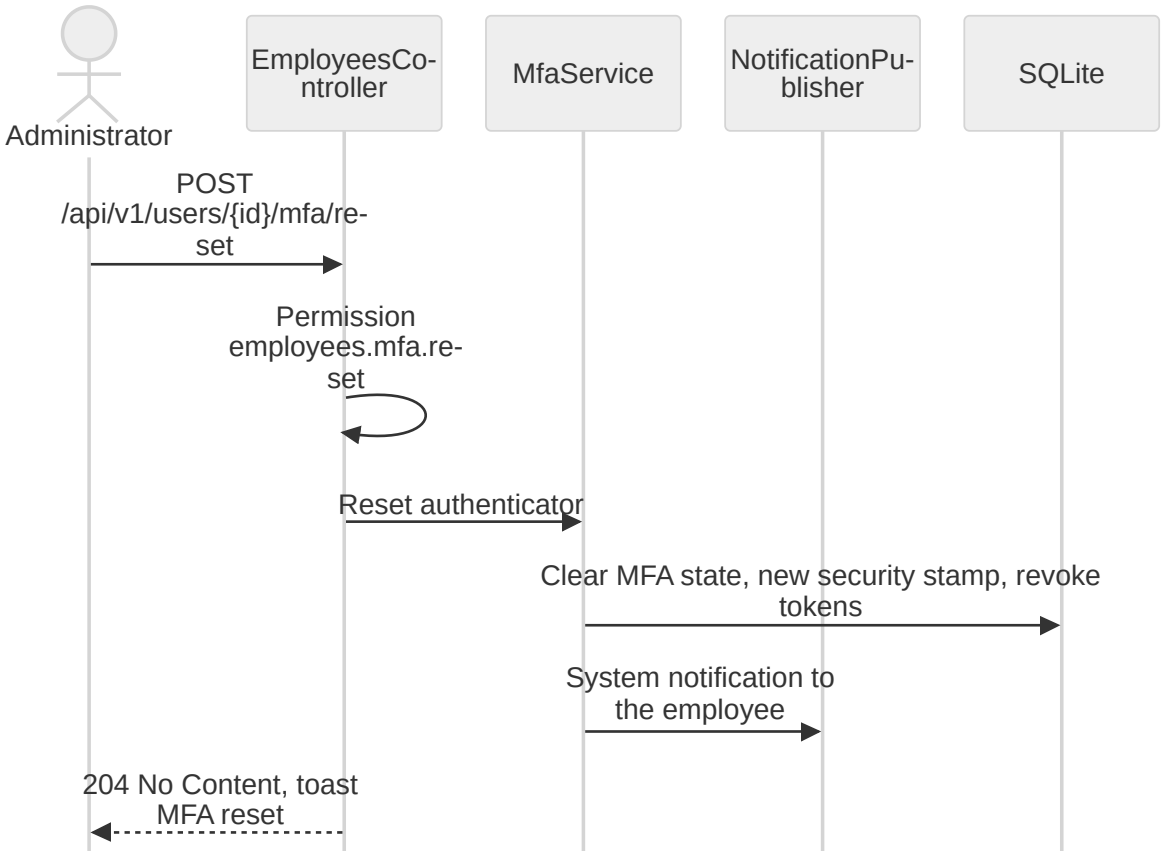
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8.3 Delete an employee



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8.4 Reset MFA (integration with Authentication and Notification)



9. Security Architecture

Concern	Approach
Authentication	Shared JWT + refresh cookie and mandatory MFA (overall HLD). EMP endpoints sit behind the MFA set-up gate
Authorization	One permission policy per action (`employees.view` , `employees.create` , `employees.edit` , `employees.status.change` , `employees.delete` , `employees.mfa.reset`). Inline checks: a non-Employee role needs `employees.role.assign` ; giving or removing the Administrator role needs `roles.administrator.assign` (not assignable to custom roles). Reading another person's single record needs `employees.edit` . Legacy `employees.manage` expands to the finer keys
Business guards	Last active Administrator, self delete, unfinished tasks – all in `EmployeeService` , so every caller (UI, API, Assistant) is covered
Session control	Security-stamp rotation plus refresh-token revocation on username or role change, deactivation, delete and MFA reset; `SessionValidation` also refreshes role and permission claims on every request
Data protection	Temporary password stored only as a hash (`IPasswordHasher<User>`); passwords are ignored on update; MFA secrets are protected by Authentication
Data scope	None – the list is organisation-wide for any holder of `employees.view`
Transport	HTTPS and the `SpaClient` CORS policy (overall HLD)

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Concern	Approach
Auditing	Refused requests are audited by the shared denied-action handler; request logging records each call; there is no change history for employee edits (§14)

10. Technology Stack

EMP uses the shared TaskFlow stack without additions – ASP.NET Core on .NET 10 (`net10.0`) with EF Core SQLite 10.0.12 and FluentValidation 12.2.0 on the server, and Angular 19.2 standalone components with signals and RxJS 7.8 in the browser. Versions and reasons are in the overall HLD (`../../00-Overall/HLD-TaskFlow-Overall.md`, §10).

11. Deployment Architecture

EMP has no deployment unit of its own: it ships inside the single `TaskFlow.Api` process and the Angular bundle, and its data lives in `taskflow.db` in the TaskFlow data folder. See the overall HLD (`../../00-Overall/HLD-TaskFlow-Overall.md`, §11) for hosts, environments and ports.

12. Non-Functional Design

Area	Design decision
Performance	List filtering happens on the server; derived managers and team are loaded with batched join queries (correlated subqueries do not translate on SQLite); the SPA debounces search and cancels outdated requests
Scalability	No paging; suitable for one organisation's staff list on a single server
Reliability	Every action is one unit-of-work save; unique indexes turn a uniqueness race into 409 "That value is already in use."
Availability	Same as the API process (overall HLD)
Security	Immediate session end (NFR-EMP-01) and server-side checks (NFR-EMP-02); hashed passwords (NFR-EMP-03)
Usability	Confirmation dialogs for deactivate, delete and MFA reset (NFR-EMP-04); every refusal returns a plain-language `detail` shown in a toast (NFR-EMP-05)
Maintainability	Layer and folder structure enforced by architecture tests; allocation rules in one shared service
Observability	Shared request logging; no dedicated audit trail
Backup & Recovery	Covered by the data-folder backup in the overall HLD

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13. Design Decisions

ID	Decision	Alternatives considered	Rationale
D-EMP-1	Soft delete for users; email (by local part) and username stay reserved for ever	Hard delete; anonymise and free the identifiers	Tasks, comments and mail keep a valid author and reports stay correct (BR-EMP-07); reserved identifiers avoid mixing a new person with an old history (BR-EMP-03)
D-EMP-2	End sessions by rotating the security stamp and revoking refresh tokens, checked on every request	Wait for the access token to expire; a token deny-list	Takes effect on the next request without extra storage (NFR-EMP-01)
D-EMP-3	Derive managers and a Manager's team from department managers and project-manager flags	A typed "reports to" field on the user	One source of truth that cannot drift from the organisation structure (BR-EMP-12)
D-EMP-4	Departments and allocations can be set only on create; afterwards DEPT and PROJ own them	Editable in the employee form	One writer per relationship after creation and a simpler edit form (BR-EMP-11)
D-EMP-5	Allocation rules live in the shared `UserAllocationService` (used by EMP and PROJ)	Separate checks per screen	The 100% cap and per-row rules cannot diverge between the two entry points (BR-EMP-10)
D-EMP-6	Last-Administrator, self-delete and unfinished-task guards in the service layer	Checks only in the UI or the controller	Covers the Assistant path and direct API calls as well as the screen (BR-EMP-04 – BR-EMP-06)
D-EMP-7	Role-assignment rights checked inline in the controller on top of the action policy	Separate "change role" endpoint	Keeps one update call while still requiring `employees.role.assign` and `roles.administrator.assign` (BR-EMP-09)
D-EMP-8	Server-side search and filters, no paging, debounced in the SPA	Client-side filtering; server paging	The filter query also serves other screens; list sizes are small for one organisation
D-EMP-9	MFA reset is delegated to the Authentication `MfaService`, which also publishes the notice	Reset logic inside `EmployeeService`	Authentication owns MFA state and protection of secrets

14. Risks, Assumptions & Open Issues

Type	Description	Mitigation / owner
Risk	⚠️ To be confirmed: the Assistant role-change tool needs only `roles.manage`; neither it nor `AssistantActionService` checks `employees.role.assign` or `roles.administrator.assign` (R-EMP-05)	Decide whether the Assistant path must apply the controller's inline checks – Jojo George
Risk	The details panel always shows **Edit**; the server refuses the save without `employees.edit` (R-EMP-06)	⚠️ To be confirmed whether the button should be hidden – Jojo George

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Type	Description	Mitigation / owner
Risk	A custom role without `projects.view` / `departments.view` gets empty filter and form lists, because load errors are swallowed (R-EMP-04)	Grant the view keys together with employee keys
Risk	No audit trail of employee changes (who changed a role or deactivated someone)	Request logging only; ⚠️ To be confirmed whether an audit log is needed
Open issue	Reading another person's single record needs `employees.edit`, while the list returns the same data with `employees.view`	Jojo George
Open issue	⚠️ To be confirmed: the role-permission matrix lists `roles.administrator.assign` as configurable, the permission catalogue marks it not assignable; this design follows the catalogue	Jojo George
Open issue	⚠️ To be confirmed: the frontend positions service file imported by the form panel is missing from the source snapshot	Jojo George
Assumption	One organisation, one email domain; list sizes allow an unpaged list	–

15. Traceability (requirements → components)

FRD items	Module / component	Section
FR-EMP-01 – FR-EMP-11 (list, columns, count, search, filters, empty states)	`EmployeeListComponent` › `UserService` › `EmployeesController` › `EmployeeService` › `EmployeeRepository` (filtered list); Role Configuration role options	§5, §6.3
FR-EMP-12, FR-EMP-13, FR-EMP-15 (menu, route, buttons, no Delete on own row)	Route `permissionGuard` with `EmployeeScreenPermissions`, menu item, permission-driven buttons in `EmployeeListComponent`	§5, §9
FR-EMP-14 (server-side refusal)	`[RequirePermission]` policies and inline checks in `EmployeesController`	§9
FR-EMP-16 – FR-EMP-19 (activate / deactivate)	`EmployeeListComponent` › `EmployeesController` › `EmployeeService` (last-Administrator rule, session end)	§8.2, §9
FR-EMP-20 – FR-EMP-27 (delete)	`EmployeesController` › `EmployeeService` (guards, soft delete, session end, manager-duty clean-up) › `TaskRepository`	§8.3, D-EMP-1
FR-EMP-28 – FR-EMP-33 (details, derived managers, team)	`EmployeeDetailsPanelComponent` › `EmployeeRepository` (batched derivation)	§6.3, D-EMP-3
FR-EMP-34 – FR-EMP-38 (MFA reset)	`EmployeeDetailsPanelComponent` › `EmployeesController` › `MfaService` › `NotificationPublisher`	§8.4, D-EMP-9
FR-EMP-39 – FR-EMP-45 (create, email policy, uniqueness, password, status)	`EmployeeFormPanelComponent` › validators › `EmployeeService` (`EmailPolicy`, uniqueness incl. deleted, password hasher); unique indexes	§8.1, §12

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FRD items	Module / component	Section
FR-EMP-46, FR-EMP-47 (role assignment rights)	Inline checks in `EmployeesController`; role select locked in `EmployeeFormPanelComponent`	§9, D-EMP-7
FR-EMP-48 – FR-EMP-52 (departments and allocations on create)	`EmployeeFormPanelComponent` (100% bar, `PositionComboboxComponent`) › `UserAllocationService`	§5, D-EMP-5
FR-EMP-53 – FR-EMP-55 (edit scope, password ignored, sign-out notice)	`EmployeeFormPanelComponent` (view-only allocations) › `EmployeeService`	D-EMP-4
FR-EMP-56 – FR-EMP-59 (session end, self sign-out, last Administrator, manager duties)	`EmployeeService` › `SessionValidation`; SPA signs out the current user after a self change	§8.2, D-EMP-2, D-EMP-6
FR-EMP-60 (save confirmation)	`EmployeeFormPanelComponent` / `EmployeeListComponent` toasts	§5

Coverage: FR-EMP-01 – FR-EMP-60 (60 of 60) map to at least one component.

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